

Oil price rip-off

With the Goods and Services Tax (GST) touching off a new round of patronage appointments by the government (this time to take control of the Liberal-dominated Senate) a more immediate financial concern for Canadians has taken a bit of a back seat.

We are referring to the recent hike in oil prices and the threat of still further increases which would take the cost of a litre of gasoline on a giddy race toward the 70 cent barrier and perhaps well beyond if new rumors are true. And from there....well, who really knows?

Because of our basic distrust of big business/industry, and going by recent history, we are immediately suspicious of the latest price spiral.

We're more than aware that there is a Middle East crisis and that was the first excuse for the price hike(s).

Should this crisis continue for an extended period we'd be much more likely to believe that excuse and accept the consequences.

But why the early move to higher oil prices? Aren't there any reserves?

The Consumer's Association of Canada believes the oil companies have taken one look at the Gulf crisis and seized it as an excuse to boost prices and, naturally, their revenues.

And frankly, so do we. One can almost imagine the dollar signs lighting up in the eyes of the oil company execs.

It is also interesting to note that U.S. President George Bush, whose country is much more involved in the Persian Gulf region, is cushioning the effect (for the time being at least) of threatened higher oil prices by releasing reserves into the marketplace.

According to our information Canada too has several months (at least three) worth of oil reserves and yet within weeks of the crisis the upward march began, region by region.

The most telling point occurred last week when the price of oil dropped by some \$5 a barrel on the world market, in response to the fact there simply isn't a shortage, Middle East crisis or no Middle East crisis!

But at the very same time oil prices jumped, for the second time in two weeks, in areas of Eastern Ontario and Western Quebec.

The oil companies then changed their tune and said they are "catching up". That the price of gas should have gone up "10 cents a litre" some time ago.

One of the more interesting quotes from an oil company spokesman was "we (companies) knew Ottawa was ready for it."

Judging from the wide-ranging comments we've heard on the subject in recent days we are quick to assure the oil companies that people here expected the hikes, but they are anything but happy and they aren't prepared to pay them.

The financial pressure on Canadians is rising all the time and paying more for gasoline is just the latest blow.

And with winter almost upon us we're certain that the cost of heating oil will also reflect the upward spiral we're currently caught in.

We're more than aware that, on a world-wide comparison basis, North American oil prices are relatively cheap, especially when compared to Europe.

However we're also talking about totally different societies. On the more confined European continent fewer people own motor vehicles. Highly advanced public transportation does the job.

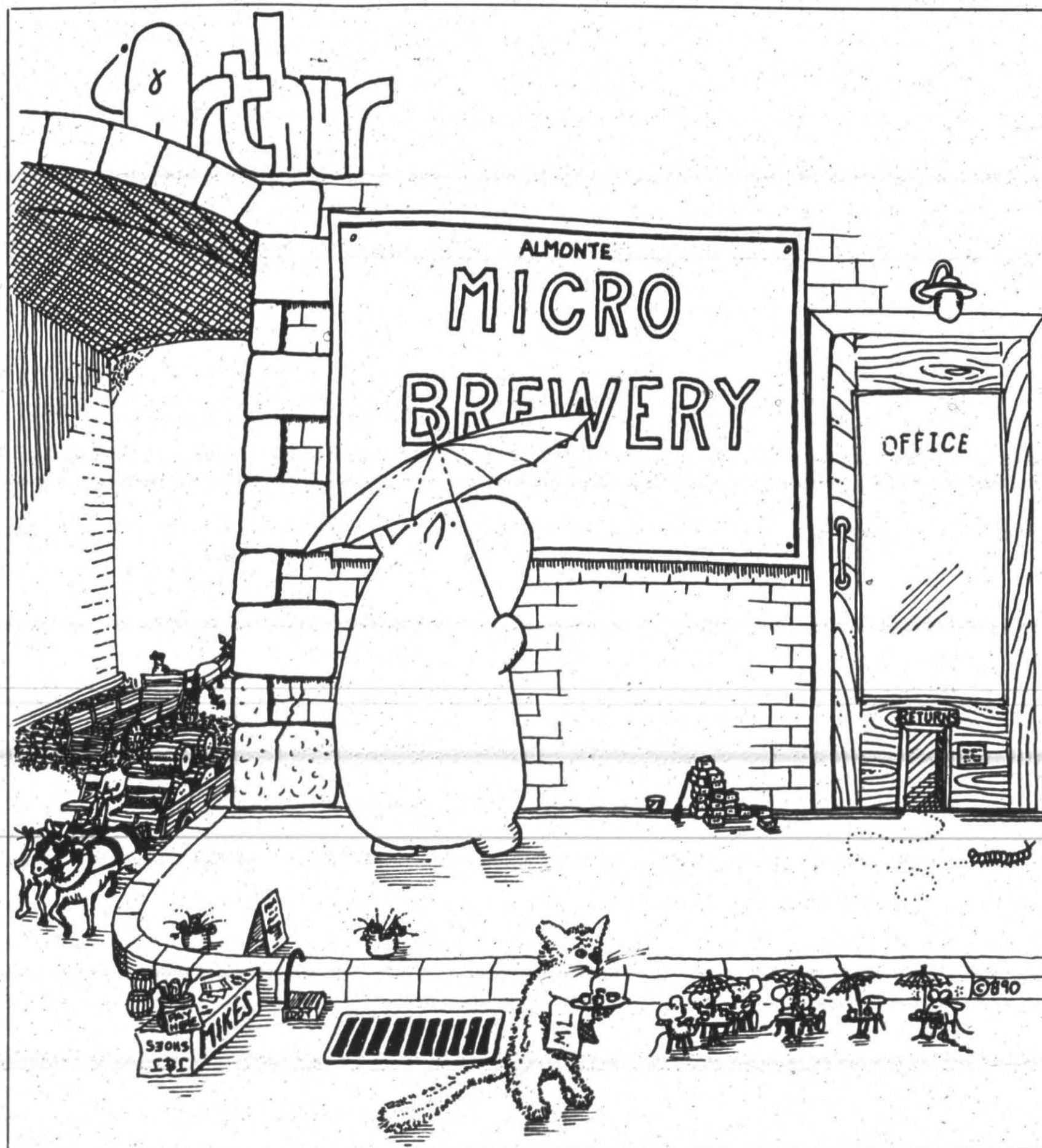
In the vast reaches of North America it's a different story.

And with the cost of almost everything on a seemingly endless upward climb, the immediate move by Canadian oil companies to increase prices is just another blow to the already overstretched pocketbooks of middle income Canadians.

Will there ever be an end to it?

The answer to that is, not unless the government chooses to do something. And the way this government operates the likelihood of that is about the same as the likelihood of another 30 degree (celsius) day before next summer!

Opinion



Give thanks throughout the entire year

So, do you still have some leftover turkey? With Thanksgiving having just past, most of us would be having reheated turkey, turkey sandwiches, turkey a la king, turkey soup and so on for a few days yet. But do we have any other Thanksgiving leftovers? I'm not talking about potatoes, cranberry sauce or stuffing. Do we have any other Thanksgiving leftovers?

The original purpose of the holiday of Thanksgiving was to give thanks to God for the harvest. To thank the Lord for the supply of food, to thank Him for all that we have on our table, because of His grace and love. Thanksgiving has naturally become a time in which we thank God for all that He has done for us and given to us. Do we have any Thanksgiving leftovers? Do we still have thanks for God in all that He has done for us and given to us, or have we finished giving our thanks for another year?

Life Worth Living

by Rev. Grant Wilson



That's one of the dangers when we set a special day aside each year to commemorate something, we tend to forget about it the rest of the year. Unless you were affected directly, how many of us consider the sacrifice made by our soldiers except on Remembrance Day? How many of us think of the birth of the

Son of God, except at Christmas? So too, how many of us take the time to thank God for all He's done, except at Thanksgiving?

One of the Old Testament hymn writers wrote these words to express His thanks to God: "Give thanks to the Lord, for He is good. His love endures forever. Give thanks to the God of gods. His love endures forever. Give thanks to the Lord of lords. His love endures forever." This hymn writer then goes on to describe the many things for which he is thankful to God: His creative power, His understanding, His love and grace, the salvation He brings, His dominion over the rulers of this world and so on and so on.

The writer of psalm 136, expresses an overwhelming sense of thanksgiving to God for all that He has done, for all that He's given. And the psalmist does not find it sufficient to say "thanks" and to leave it at that. Over and over again, the

psalmist gives his thanks to God. Thanking the Lord was just a part of his life, a part of what he did.

When we truly consider all that the Lord has done for us, all that he has given us, should we not desire to follow the example of this hymn writer. Our God has given of His supply in providing a great harvest. He has blessed us with family and friends. He has given us His love. But most of all, the Father has given us His own dear Son, as a sacrifice for our sins, that whoever believes in Him should be forgiven and have life eternal - is that not something for which we should be thankful?

Do you have any Thanksgiving leftovers? May our thanks to God last far beyond the turkey. May our thanks to God be with us at all times - Give thanks to the Lord, for He is good. His love endures forever.

Recycling depot was another big success

Thanks to one and all for contributing to the recent recycling depot, held last Saturday, Sept. 29. And just in case you don't have time to read any further, the next depot will be held on Saturday, Nov. 24, so start saving your recyclable materials now!

In spite of the drizzle during the early part of the September depot, we had a solid showing from both willing recyclers and those who gave up at least part of their Saturday to help keep things running smoothly.

As in the past, the materials that were received at the depot included colored and non-colored (clear) glass, food and beverage cans, corrugated cardboard and newspaper. We also began the trial collection of PET bottles at this depot to see whether the volume would warrant the addition of this material to the program.

And the bottom line? The Recycling Depot is most definitely a worthwhile exercise. Nearly 11 dumpsters full of recyclable waste was collected and diverted from the landfill sites maintained by the municipalities of Almonte and Ramsay. Eleven dumpsters! That's the equivalent of over 200 cubic yards (or 80 tons) of material (especially with all those water-logged Ottawa Citizens!).

With present landfill costs running in the range of \$50 to \$70/ton, last Saturday's 80 ton collection represents a savings of anywhere from \$4,000 to \$5,600 to our community. Of course there was a cost to run the depot as well. We pay for the transportation of the materials and the use of the containers during the weekend of the depot. There

Environmental Action Committee Report

are also advertising costs and the time spent by several staff members in the works department. However, the total cost for the Almonte-Ramsay Recycling Depot probably won't exceed \$2,000. That's a pretty good return on our investment, especially when we don't have to account for the many hours of volunteer effort that comes for free.

Some of that volunteer labor contributes directly to the success of the collection, particularly the curbside pickup of newspapers in Almonte which is performed by the Civitans. Although a great many people will bring all of their recyclables to the depot at one time (newspaper included), it would seem that there are still many people who will only save newspapers because they can't, or won't take the other recyclable items to the depot themselves.

For anyone who wants to get started on the "recycling thing" the following information should help to clarify exactly what materials can be recycled at our local depot:

Glass
Your glass should be sorted into colored and non-colored (clear). Use a couple of fairly stout cardboard boxes (that can be re-used) when you are setting your bottles aside in your home. Almost any glass container that was used for a food or beverage is recyclable and all that you have to do is rinse the empty containers and remove the lids and neck

rings (if possible). The companies that buy recycled glass are very particular about what they will and won't accept and unfortunately we have little choice but to comply. The list of things that they definitely won't take includes ceramics, china, window panes, drinking glasses, mirrors, light bulbs or those dark brown medicine bottles.

Cans
Once again we can take food and beverage cans only. The only thing we ask is that, like your glass, you rinse the cans (especially the food cans) and remove the paper labels. If you can flatten your cans, so much the better but it isn't absolutely necessary. We cannot take paint cans, aerosols, foil wrap or other bulky scrap metals (check with your local waste or scrap contractor though, many of these other items can be recycled by them).

Newspaper
Organize your newspapers into manageable bundles—either put them into paper bags or tie them with regular string. Don't tie your papers with plasticized or nylon cord, or put the bundles into plastic bags, because they'll need to be unbundled before going into the bin. Also, as you save your papers you should remove and discard any glossy inserts or magazines as the glossy (clay-coated) paper is not recyclable at this time.

Cardboard
Any corrugated cardboard boxes that

are dry and relatively clean are fair game. Just flatten them and tie them with regular string. Non-recyclable materials include soap and cereal boxes and any similar containers made of single ply paperboard.

PET bottles
So what the heck is a PET bottle? No, it isn't the jar that your daughter brought home a frog in last July. PET stands for polyethylene terephthalate, a type of plastic resin that is used to make many of the soft drink containers that you see in the stores these days. They come in all shapes but the most common ones are the 2-litre size. They may or may not have a black plastic base and they are fairly flexible when empty. Just remember to remove the tops as you set them aside for recycling (otherwise they are virtually uncrushable).

So that's the scoop on the recyclables. The next Recycling Depot is scheduled for Saturday, Nov. 24, and will likely be at the Almonte Town Yard. Watch your Gazette for more information.

As a means of encouraging more participation by residents in Ramsay Township, especially for people living in or near the villages of Clayton, Appleton, and Blakeney, it has been proposed that half-day mini-depots be held in these communities on the same day as the main Recycling Depot (the Village of Lanark has been doing this very successfully for several months). You probably wouldn't need any more than a utility trailer and a couple of volunteers in each location. Anyone interested in pursuing this idea is encouraged to phone Brad Jones at 256-1390.

Letters

Trees destroyed, students annoyed

These are just two of the over 20 letters received by The Gazette from concerned youngsters who found their three trees, planted recently at G.L. Comba Public School to help preserve the environment, destroyed by vandals.

To the Editor:

I am writing to tell you about an incident that happened at G.L. Comba School. Our trees were broken by people who don't respect our environment. One was broken down in the summer. The other two were broken down last weekend. I am both sad, mad, and angry. The trees' names were "Leonardo Twig", "G.L.", and "Hope". I hope that the new trees that are being planted don't get destroyed. Those people wouldn't like their property destroyed.

Yours truly,
Pamela Paterson
Grade 4,
G.L. Comba P.S.

To the Editor:

We are very sad and concerned about what happened at G.L. Comba school last weekend. We planted three trees, one on Earth Day and two in the Spring. Last weekend, someone snapped the trunks of all our trees. We would like to find out who broke our trees and we would say to them, "Please have more respect for your environment, we wanted our trees to grow big and give some shade."

From Jamie Blades
and Jamie Barker,
G.L. Comba School, Almonte.

Poetry corner

I was sitting alone one evening
Thinking of the past
Those days when I was happy
But times like those don't last

The days when children were young

And life seemed at its best
Arthur was called to leave us all
To that Home of peace and rest

Today as I sit alone
Families all are gone
But memories keep coming back

As I think of my old home

Some day if I am spared
Old memories are all I know
I'll look back on other days
When my hair is white as snow

But I have much to be thankful for
I've been spared so many years
My family are all in their own homes
But memories oft bring a tear.

Cora Yuill.